MIL-T-40097B

18 June 1968
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-40097A
1 May 1963

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TONGS, FOOD SERVING

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers one type of food serving tongs.

1.2 Classification.- Food serving tongs shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 6 inches long

Size 2 - 9 inches long

Size 3 - 12 inches long

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or requests for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

* FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding Paperboard
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard Corrugated and Solid Sheet, Stock, Container Grade and Cut Shapes

FSC 7330

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads 40" x 48" 4 Way Partial and 4 Way Pallet.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications.- The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

Standard A 167-63 - Corrosion-Resisting Chromium-Nickel Steel Plate, Sheet, and Strip

Standard A 176-63 - Corrosion-Resisting Chromium Steel Plate, Sheet, and Strip

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103.)

* NATIONAL SANITATION FOUNDATION (NSF)

Criteria C-2 - The Evaluation of Special Equipment and/or Devices

Listing of Food Service Equipment

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Sanitation Foundation, P.O. Box 1468, Ann Arbor, Michigan 48106.)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 First article.- When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample end item shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of the responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Standard product.- The food serving tongs delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's commercial current product, except for any changes necessary to comply with specification requirements.

* 3.3 NSF standard.- Tongs shall conform to the applicable requirements of NSF Criteria C-2.

* 3.3.1 NSF certification.- The supplier shall submit satisfactory evidence to the contracting officer or his authorized representative that the tongs he proposes to furnish under this specification meets the applicable requirements of NSF Criteria C-2 as follows:

(1) Listing in the current edition of the NSF "Listing of Food Equipment" or display of the NSF seal on the finished tongs, shall be submitted prior to approval of the preproduction sample, if one is submitted, or prior to approval of the first shipment.

-or-

(2) A certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the medical department of the service for which the tongs are being procured, indicating that the tongs, food serving have been tested and conform to NSF Criteria C-2 shall be submitted prior to the approval of the preproduction sample, if one is submitted, or prior to commencing production.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Materials.- The materials shall be corrosion-resisting steel sheets and strips conforming to the chemical composition of the ASTM Standards A 167-63 or A 176-63.

3.5 Design.- The food serving tongs shall be formed without seams and shall conform to the dimensions specified in figure 1. Commercial tolerance shall apply to the material thickness dimensions of figure 1. The jaws may have a sawtooth configuration.

3.5.1 Spring action.- The action of the food serving tongs shall be such that the open end shall spring open after compression and remain in the open position. The open position for applicable size tongs required shall be not less than specified in figure 1 E dimension before and after testing (see 4.4.1).

3.6 Finish.- The food serving tongs shall be finished in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

3.7 Marking for identification.- The food serving tongs shall have the manufacturer's name, trade name, or trademark of such known characters as to be easily identifiable with the manufacturer. Marking shall be applied in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.8 Workmanship.- The finished food serving tongs shall be clean, well made and free from burrs, sharp edges, or any other defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2 First article inspection.- When a preproduction sample is required it shall be examined for defects listed in table I and dimensions specified and tested as specified in 4.4.1.

4.3 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1, components and material shall be inspected and tested in accordance with the requirements of the referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in the specification or applicable purchase document.

* 4.3.2 End item inspection.- The lot shall consist of all food serving tongs of one size offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated food serving tongs.

* 4.3.2.1 Visual examination.- Examination shall be made of the food serving tongs for defects listed in table I. The inspection level shall be II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.5 for major defects and 4.0 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I.- Classification of visual defects

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Finish | Not finished as specified | | X |
| Design and workmanship | Sharp or burred edges or projection which might cause injury | X | |
| | Rust, pits, and stains not removed | | X |
| | Not specified type | X | |
| | Not design as specified | X | |
| Marking for identification | Omitted, illegible, missing, incomplete | | X |

* 4.3.2.2 Dimensional examination.- Examination shall be of the complete food serving tongs to determine compliance with dimensional requirements. Any dimension not within the specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 1.5 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 4.3.2.3 End item testing.- Testing shall be performed for the spring action in accordance with 4.4.1. The inspection level shall be S-2 and AQL shall be 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

* 4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking are in compliance with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II.- Examination of preparation for delivery

| Examination | Defect |
|---|---|
| Marking | Missing, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application |
| Materials | Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective |
| Contents | Incorrect item and number per container is more or less than required |

* 4.3.3.1 Examination of shipping containers.- When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterprooting, and strapping shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636.

4.4 Testing.-

4.4.1 Testing for spring action.- The food serving tongs shall be tested as follows to determine compliance with 3.4.1. Compress the tongs until the open ends close. Release the pressure permitting the closed ends to spring open. Repeat this cycle 25 times.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A.- Six size 1 or size 2 tongs, or three size 3 tongs shall be packaged in a snug-fitting folding or set-up paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III, type B, class A of PPP-B-566 or type I, variety 1, class A



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

style 3 or 4 of PPP-B-676, respectively. The tongs shall be nested and interleaved with tissue paper in a manner to minimize cube and prevent the tongs from contacting each other. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

* 5.1.2 Level C.- The tongs shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Four-hundred and thirty-two size 1 or size 2 tongs, or two-hundred and eighty-eight size 3 tongs, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed by means of tape, and reinforced with flat strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2 Level B.- Four hundred and thirty-two size 1 or size 2 tongs, or two hundred and eighty-eight size 3 tongs, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2) the shipping container shall be V3c or V3s, fabricated and closed in accordance with PPP-B-636. The shipping container material may also be grade V4s of PPP-F-320.

5.2.3 Level C.- Tongs packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

* 5.3 Palletization.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), tongs, packed as specified, shall be palletized in accordance with Load Type I of MIL-STD-147, except that for overseas shipment the over-all height of the load shall not exceed 43-inches. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Container patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the container patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the container pattern used shall be approved by the contracting officer.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The food serving tongs covered by this specification are intended to provide sanitary food handling.

* 6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Size required (see 1.2).

(c) First article.- When preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).

(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(e) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

(f) When palletization is not required (see 5.3.).

6.3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content as written irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL

Navy - SA

Air Force - 84

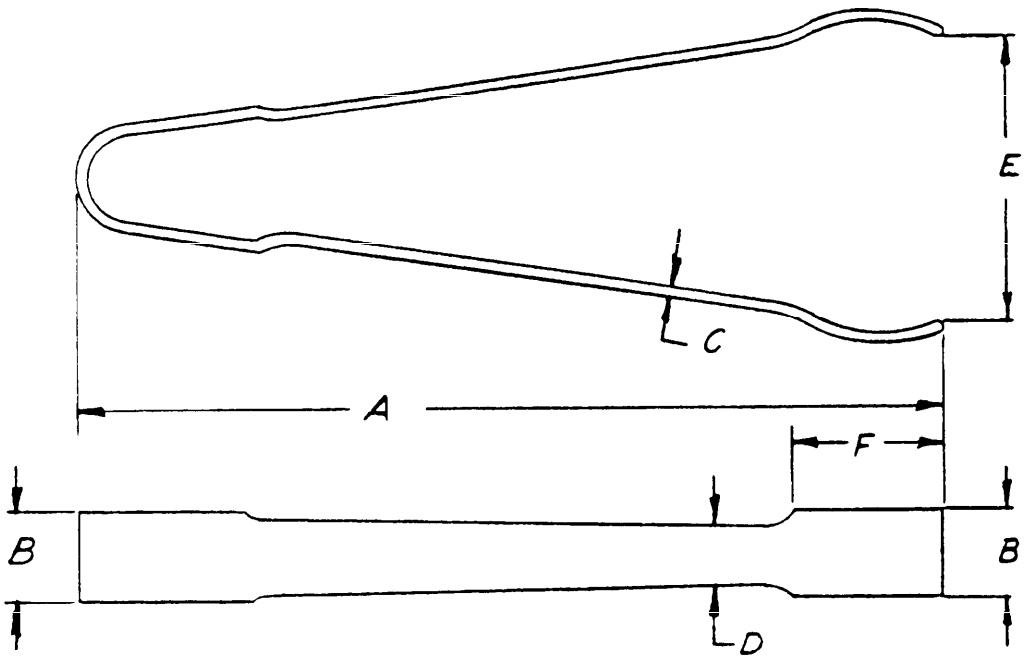
Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 7330-0237



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.




| SIZE | A INCHES | B INCHES | C | D IN. MIN. | E IN. MIN. | F IN. MIN. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | $6 \pm \frac{1\frac{1}{4}}{\frac{1}{4}}$ | $\frac{3}{4} \pm \frac{1}{16}$ | .0250 (24GA.) | $\frac{9}{16}$ | $2\frac{3}{8}$ | $\frac{3}{4}$ |
| 2 | $9 \pm \frac{3}{8}$ | $\frac{15}{16} \pm \frac{1}{16}$ | .0312 (22GA.) | $\frac{5}{8}$ | $3\frac{1}{4}$ | $\frac{13}{16}$ |
| 3 | $12 \pm \frac{1}{2}$ | $1\frac{1}{8} \pm \frac{1}{16}$ | .0375 (20GA.) | $\frac{7}{8}$ | 3 | 1 |

FIGURE 1. FOOD SERVING TONGS



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
U. S. Army Natick Laboratories
Natick, Massachusetts 01760

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS

Commanding General
U. S. Army Natick Laboratories
ATTN: AMXRES-BQS
Natick, Massachusetts 01760

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

# SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

Tongs, Food Serving - MIL-T-40097B

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

[ ] YES [ ] NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

**DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426** REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.